

# MODERNISE YOUR HOME WITH SMART LED BULBS

EFY Bureau

**W**e have come a long way from manual operations to automation in the smallest aspects of our life. Smart bulb technology provides us the luxury of switching on or off the lights without getting up or while on-the-move. Wi-Fi-compatible smart LED bulbs can be controlled from any part of the world. All it takes is an app on the phone, tablet, home automation hub or voice assistant such as Amazon Alexa and Google Home to brighten the house.

## Essential features

Apart from being controlled remotely, smart LED bulbs have numerous other features. These provide a range of 16 million colour options. These can use the GPS of a cellphone and switch on the lights before you walk into the house. Some products can automatically alter the brightness based on what you are watching on TV. Smart LED bulbs can be Bluetooth- or Wi-Fi-compatible.

Smart bulbs have a simple installation process: screw the bulb on, download the app on

the phone and select the device.

You can also save energy with LED technology. A few advanced smart bulbs can be linked with alarm systems. These can dim or brighten the lights when a social media message or WhatsApp notification is received on the cellphone. Using Internet of Things (IoT) technology, smart LED bulbs can also be switched on with rainfall.

## Popular smart LED bulbs available in the market

While picking up a smart LED bulb for your home, you must first look at the connection requirements. It can be through Wi-Fi, proprietary hub or a third-party smart home hub. A Wi-Fi-based smart bulb should be chosen only if you need more than one bulb in the house. Each bulb is considered as an individual Wi-Fi device and will consume some bandwidth. In case of multiple smart devices, you do not want to juggle different apps for different devices.

To light up every corner of your house with smart bulbs, you can go for a proprietary hub that acts as a central device for controlling all bulbs through a single app. If you have an existing smart home hub, check for compatibility before installing any new smart bulbs. We also recommend checking the warranty and lifespan. In this article we look at some options based on price, availability and essential features.

**Wipro Garnet smart light 7W B22**

**LED smart bulb.** These bulbs do not require a hub and can be operated from Wipro Smart Next Home app. These are compatible with Amazon Alexa and Google Assistant, and allow you to schedule auto switching on and off for the lights based on the time of day. Multiple lights can be grouped by room name and then all of them can be controlled from the app. These bulbs do not require any additional connectors—bulbs can be plugged in the traditional sockets.



These bulbs are also compatible with IFTTT, through which you can set specific colours for new email or other notifications. These do not work with Siri—this should not be an issue as there are multiple other ways to control the device.

The only concern, however, is brightness. A 7W bulb will not be suitable for a big room and you might need to use more than one. The product is available on e-commerce websites and retail stores at a price of ₹ 900 to ₹ 1000, and has a two-year warranty.

**Syska smart light 7W LED bulb.** This Wi-Fi-enabled product